

Oravia

Grammar

1. Typological Overview

Oravia is an analytic language. Words do not change shape to mark agreement, gender, number, or tense. The same word can function as a noun, verb, adjective, or adverb depending on context. All grammatical relationships are signaled by small marker words, not by modifying the words themselves.

Key features:

- No articles (no "the" or "a")
- No grammatical gender (except optional suffixes)
- No plural forms (except for personal pronouns)
- No verb conjugation
- No obligatory tense marking, aspect is optional and always explicit
- Flexible word order at the sentence level: markers determine role
- Words are built from cluster sounds that carry consistent meanings

2. Phonology

2.1 Consonants

The consonants are: B C D F G H J L M N P R S T V W Y

All pronounced as expected in English, with these specific values:

Letter	IPA	Sounds like
c	/k/	cake (Oravia has no letter k)
h	/h/, /ɸ/, or /x/	variable, from English h to a soft rasp
j	/dʒ/	jello
r	/r/	the tt in butter, like a flap

Similar-sounding pairs: The vocabulary is designed so that similar pairs never need to be disambiguated: l/r, m/n, p/b, t/d, c/g, f/v, w/v. There is no word that differs from another only by one of these pairs. In practice, you can use similar pronunciations without causing confusion.

Consonant endings: Some syllables end in a consonant. If you find this hard to pronounce, insert a short unstressed i after it (morta or mor(i)ta are both fine).

2.2 Vowels

The vowels are: A E I O U

Letter	IPA	Sounds like
a	/ɑ/	father
e	/ɛ/	cellar
i	/i/	creek
o	/ɔ/	door
u	/u/	flu

Pronouncing E and O closed as in Spanish (/e/ and /o/) is also perfectly fine.

Two vowels together: The preference is to pronounce adjacent vowels as one syllable (as in oRAvia), but two syllables is also acceptable. LiRia (preferred) or liRia (also fine).

2.3 Stress

Stress always falls on the penultimate syllable (second to last). The exception is when you have a suffix, which is stressed.

```
coupa    → COU-pa
eledora  → e-le-DO-ra
lidastor → li-DAS-tor
anparu  → an-PA-ru
anparum (anparu+um) → an-pa-RUM
```

2.4 Audio Note

Recordings may sound Romance-influenced because of my accent. Try to repeat for mutual intelligibility rather than to copy an exact accent. There is no "right" accent in Oravia.

3. Sentence Structure

3.1 Core Pattern

The fundamental sentence uses four core markers:

```
[a [subject]   i [verb]   e [direct object]   u [indirect object]
```

Marker	Role	Example
a	subject — the doer or experiencer	a nim = I
i	verb	i mo = eat
e	direct object	e mocen = chocolate
u	indirect object (to / for)	u falni = to the baby
o	focus / emphasis	o nim! = it's ME!

A basic sentence:

a	nim	i	mo	e	mocen
	I		eat		chocolate

Prepositions:

Word	Meaning	Example
de	of / from	de nime faibor = of my spouse
en	time and space	en bo = at home

3.2 Word Order — Marker Blocks Move as Units

A marker and all the words it introduces form a block. The block moves as a unit; you never split the marker away from its phrase.

Think of it like Japanese particles. Each marked phrase is a self-contained block that can move anywhere in the sentence.

Block structure:

[en	nime	yamirli	bo]
↑	↑	↑	↑
loc	my	old	house

The entire block `en nime yamirli bo` can move to the beginning, middle, or end of the sentence. But `en` never splits from its phrase, and `yamirli` (old) always precedes `bo` (house).

Full example — I searched in my old house for many years:

nim	i	copei	en	yamirli	bo	en	mir	lidastor
-----	---	-------	----	---------	----	----	-----	----------

Four blocks: `[nim]` · `[i copei]` · `[en yamirli bo]` · `[en mir lidastor]`

All of these reordering examples are valid:

[en yamirli bo]	[nim]	[i copei]	[en mir lidastor]
[en mir lidastor]	[nim]	[i copei]	[en yamirli bo]
[nim]	[en yamirli bo]	[i copei]	[en mir lidastor]

These are NOT valid because they break a block apart:

✗	nim en i copei nime yamirli bo	(en split from its phrase)
✗	nim i copei en nime bo yamirli	(yamirli after the head noun)

Within a block, modifiers always come before what they modify. A long noun phrase like *de yamirli heivio haijor* (of the old magic witch) reads left to right, with each word narrowing the concept of what follows.

3.3 Dropping Markers

Markers can be omitted when meaning is clear from context. The *a* (subject) marker drops most easily, especially with pronouns. The *e* marker drops when the object is unambiguous. The *u* marker is rarely dropped.

Full:	a nim i mo e mocen	
Standard:	nim i mo e mocen	(a dropped)
Casual:	nim i mo mocen	(a and e dropped)
Very casual:	i mo?	(just the verb)

4. Pronouns

4.1 Personal Pronouns

Singular		Plural	
nim	I / me	nima	we / us
run	you	runa	you all
hay	he / she / it (singular)	haya	they (plural)

hay is fully gender-neutral. It covers he, she, it, and any singular third person.

4.2 Possessive Pronouns

Add *-e* to any personal pronoun:

Pronoun → Possessive	Meaning
nim → nime	my / mine
run → rune	your / yours
hay → haye	his / her / its
nima → nimaē	our
haya → hayaē	their

For non-pronoun possession, use *de*:

de nime faibor → my spouse's

4.3 When Possessives Are Omitted

Oravia omits possessives when ownership is obvious: body parts, family roles, clothing, body actions:

varodu toulum	→ head hurts (not: my head)
farejor i anifi	→ mother is coming (not: my mother)
i siur e yesrel	→ remove the jacket (not: your jacket)

5. The Copula

The copula (to be) uses the double a pattern. There is no separate verb "to be."

a [subject]	a	[predicate]
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Examples:

a nim a yalen	→ I am tall
a haya a ti	→ they are bad
a coupa a ancem hue	→ the card is turned
a nim a roweir hai	→ I am a teacher
a bo a no leayo	→ the house is like a garden

If you want to say something like "someone is at a location", you can use just the preposition:

nim en gedom	→ I am in the bank
nim [en] noi	→ I am here

6. Verbs

6.1 Lexical Flexibility

Any word can be used as a verb by placing i before it:

boemo (kitchen)	→ i boemo	= to cook
bonfene (bed)	→ i bonfene	= to lie down
bortal (door)	→ iortal	= to enter
mogali (coffee)	→ i mogali	= to drink coffee

6.2 Aspect Suffixes

Aspect marks the completion state of an action. It is optional; bare verbs are the default.

Suffix	Meaning	Feel
(bare)	general / ongoing / habitual	neutral — the default
-ar	completed action	past-like relative to the main reference
-is	not yet started	future-like relative to the main reference

-ar does not mean "past tense." It means the action is complete relative to the reference moment:

nim i moar cali run i anifi

I had already eaten when you arrived

-is marks something as not yet started:

a anseis → a future/upcoming job
litamis → tomorrow

A quick guide to when to use each:

. use the base form of the verb in general.

. when you want to specify if an action was completed, or if it was done before another action, you can use -ar

. when you want to specify if an action will yet to start, or if it follows another action, you can use -is

litamar, nim i mouje e mogali
yesterday, I drank coffee → verb in base form, natural

6.3 Negation

Add -um directly to the verb. -um on do (can) produces doum (cannot), which comes up a lot:

nim i moun e moyi → I don't eat sugar
nim i doum i siyal → I cannot find

6.4 Verb Stacking

Use the short root of the first verb, then the full second verb:

i [root] i [full verb]

Short	Full	Meaning
do	ando	can
dai	anidai	want to
fou	anifou	need to
vil	novil	must (obligation)
tane	daetane	should (recommendation)

nim i do i mo → I can eat
nim i vil i mo → I must eat
nim i tane i mo → I should eat

Short roots are the natural choice in speech. Full forms (nim i anidai i bonfene) sound formal or deliberate.

6.5 Must vs. Should

```
nim i vil i [verb] → I must [verb] – obligation  
nim i tane i [verb] → I should [verb] – recommendation
```

To negate, add -um to the inner verb: *nim i vil i moum* = I have an obligation not to eat

7. Habit and Completed Habit

lirul marks habitual or recurring action. *lirular* (-ar on *lirul*) marks a past habit that no longer holds ("used to"):

```
nim i mo e mogali lirul → I habitually drink coffee  
nim i mo e mogali lirular → I used to drink coffee (but don't  
anymore)  
hay i boemo en bo nealui lirular → she used to cook at home half the time
```

8. Immediate Aspect — *noli* with -ar and -is

Combining *noli* (now) with the aspect suffixes pins the action to the current moment specifically:

```
-ar noli = just (completed right now):  
nim i moar noli → I just ate  
hay i anifar noli → she just left  
  
-is noli = about to (starting right now):  
nim i mois noli → I'm about to eat  
hay i anifis noli → she's about to leave
```

Without *noli*, -ar and -is are relative to the narrative moment. With *noli*, they are anchored to right now. Think of it as the Oravia equivalent of "just did" and "about to."

9. Continuative Aspect

To express that an action started in the past and continues to the present ("have been doing since / for"), Oravia uses the bare verb (ongoing) with two possible time expressions:

50.1 Since a point in time — *de* + time

Use *de* (from/of) to mark the starting point. The bare verb signals the action is still ongoing:

```
nim i mo e mogali de litamar  
I have been drinking coffee since yesterday  
  
nim i eleme en 'San Antonio de lidastor teva  
I have been living in San Antonio for six years  
  
haya i damai de litam cali nim i anifar  
they have been arguing since the day I left
```

50.2 For a duration — en + span

Use en (at/in) with a duration to express how long the action has been going on without specifying the start point:

```
nim i mo e mogali en mir lidastor
I have been drinking coffee for many years

hay i copei en par lidastor
she has been searching for three years
```

The bare verb in both constructions signals the action is still active. If the action has since ended, use -ar instead: nim i moar e mogali en tor lidastor = I drank coffee for two years (and no longer do).

10. The hai and hue Suffixes

10.1 hai — Agent and Role

hai creates agent nouns: "the one who does X" or "the one whose role is X":

```
anye hai      → maker, creator
boemo hai     → cook
be hai        → traveler
heivio hai    → witch / wizard
```

To remember it: hai contains a (actor) + i (verb), the actor-verb combination.

10.2 hue — Recipient and Resultant State

hue marks the thing in a state of having been acted upon:

```
anye hue      → the made thing, a creation
a coupa a ancem hue → the card is (in the state of being) turned
```

To remember it: hue contains u (indirect) + e (object), the receiver side.

10.3 hue vs. -ar

-ar narrates that an event happened. hue describes the resulting state:

```
a coupa i ancemar → the card turned (the event)
a coupa a ancem hue → the card is turned (current state)
```

11. Gender

Oravia has no grammatical gender. hay is fully neutral. Gender can be specified optionally:

Method	Female	Male
Suffix	-jor	-jal

Prefix word	faejor	faejal
-------------	--------	--------

hayjor = she	farejor = mother
faejor fano = daughter	faejal fano = son

Gender is always optional; use it only when disambiguation is needed.

12. Negation

12.1 -um on Verbs

nim i moum e moyi	→ I don't eat sugar
nim i doum i siyal	→ I cannot find (do + um)

12.2 ho — Opposite

ho before any word creates its opposite:

a nim a ho yalen	→ I am short (not-tall)
nim i ho bonfene	→ I stand up (opposite of lie down)

Compare: -um negates; ho inverts a quality:

nim i moum e mocen	→ I don't eat chocolate (negation)
a mocen a ho yuba	→ chocolate is unpleasant (opposite quality)

13. Negation Scope

13.1 Local Negation — -um

-um on a verb negates that verb only. It's the most common form of negation in the language:

nim i moum e mocen	→ I don't eat chocolate
nim i doum i anvu	→ I cannot go

13.2 Propositional Negation — elirevaum

To negate the whole proposition (as in "it's not true that..."), use elirevaum (eli virtue + reva accurate + um = not-accurate):

elirevaum a nim i mo e mocen	
it's not true that I eat chocolate	
elirevaum hay i anifar	
it's not true that she left	

elirevaum is the most general propositional negator, used for factual corrections.

13.3 Scope-Specific Negation

Oravia has more specific scope negators for particular contexts. These are just examples not to be memorized, you can use any word in this function depending on what you want to say.

Word	Meaning	Use
elirevaum	not true	factual correction of a whole proposition
oiyarum	not the emphasis	corrects what is being highlighted: "it's not THAT, it's THIS"
datelium	not the situation	the circumstances are different, it's not the case

For most purposes, elirevaum is the right choice. Use the others when you want to be precise about what aspect of a claim you are pushing back on.

14. Questions

14.1 Yes/No Questions

Raise intonation on the same sentence. No structural change needed:

run i mo?	→ Are you eating?
a hay en bo?	→ Is she at home?

If you want, you can add in the end of the sentence: "dou ce?" (or what?) or "ia?" (yes? / right?).

14.2 Question Words

All question words are built from ce (what) plus a domain word. The pattern is open-ended, and new question words can be formed by combining ce with any relevant domain word.

Word	Built from	Meaning
ce	—	what?
cei	ce + ei (person)	who?
cedom	ce + dom (place)	where?
celi	ce + li (time)	when?
ceora	ce + ora (idea)	why?
cemir	ce + mir (many)	how many?
cenon	ce + non (way/manner)	how? (in what way?)
cene	ce + ne (gradation)	how [adjective]? (how tall? how intense?)

ce run i mo?	→ What are you eating?
cei i mouje e moulu?	→ Who is drinking milk?
cedom run i anvu?	→ Where are you going?
cemir falen i dami?	→ How many children are there?
cenon run i boemo?	→ How do you cook?

`cene yalen a run?` → How tall are you?

14.3 Connector Equivalents

In non-question sentences, question words become connectors (instead of *ce*, use *ca*):

Question	Connector	Meaning in statements
<i>ce</i>	<i>ca</i>	that / which
<i>cei</i>	<i>caei</i>	who
<i>cedom</i>	<i>cadom</i>	where
<i>celi</i>	<i>cali</i>	when
<i>ceora</i>	<i>caora</i>	because / the reason
<i>cenon</i>	<i>canon</i>	the way in which / how
<i>cene</i>	<i>cane</i>	to the degree that / as [adjective] as

`nim i siyal ca a eledora a eodyel` → I noticed that fate was joining us
`caora nim i anifar, i doum i anivari` → because I left, I couldn't return

14.4 The Multiple Meanings of "How"

"How" in English covers several distinct concepts, each handled differently in Oravia:

cenon / canon — manner (in what way)

Asks or states the method or manner of doing something:

`cenon run i boemo?` → How do you cook? (what method?)
`hay i anye canon nim i ilaluan u hay` → she does it the way I told her

cene / cane — degree (how much, how tall, how intense)

Built from *ne* (the gradation system), it asks about intensity or degree on the 0–10 scale:

`cene yalen a run?` → How tall are you?
`cene tohpu a run?` → How sad are you?
`nim i anvu cane run` → I go as much as you (to the same degree)

How much as in price follows the same logic — *ce* + the relevant money/value word. The trick is to identify which domain the "how" is about (manner, degree, price, quantity) and combine *ce* with the matching word.

15. Marker Disambiguation in Questions and Relative Clauses

Oravia's role markers can be placed directly before a question word or relative connector to specify what grammatical role the questioned or relativized element plays within its clause. It's optional when context is clear, but invaluable when a sentence would otherwise be ambiguous.

15.1 In Questions

Without a marker, *ce* (what/who) is ambiguous about its role. Placing a marker before *ce* makes it explicit:

```
e ce i mo?           → what is being eaten? (ce = direct object)
a ce i mo?           → who eats? (ce = subject)
u ce nim i ilaluan? → to whom am I speaking? (ce = indirect object)
```

The marker immediately before *ce* signals the role of the unknown. Dedicated question words like *cedom* and *cei* are shortcuts for the most common cases (*en ce* for where, *a ce* + person for who), but the marker-plus-*ce* construction is available for any role.

15.2 In Relative Clauses

The same principle applies to relative connectors. A marker before *ca* or *caei* specifies the role of the modified noun inside the embedded clause:

```
nim i none e miau a ca i mo
I have the cat [SUBJ who] eats
(the cat is the subject of eating)

nim i none e miau e ca nim i mo
I have the cat [OBJ that] I eat
(the cat is the object - I eat it)

nim i none e miau u ca nim i ilaluan
I have the cat [IO that] I speak to
(the cat is the indirect object)
```

Without the marker, the connector alone (*ca*, *caei*) leaves the role implicit and relies on context. With the marker, there is no ambiguity regardless of word order in the embedded clause.

The same principle applies to any connector:

```
a nim i vardei e hei a caei i ilaluan u run
I see the person [SUBJ who] spoke to you

a nim i vardei e hei e caei run i ilaluan
I see the person [OBJ who] you spoke to
```

The marker before the connector travels with it as a unit, just like any other marker block.

16. Connectors and Conjunctions

16.1 Basic Connectors

Word	Meaning	Example
su	and / also / with	nim i mo e mocen su e moaria
dou	or	nim i mo e mocen dou e moaria
mai	but	nim i anidai mo, mai i doum
eta	therefore / so	nim i daium, eta i anifou i mo

su is versatile: it connects nouns, verbs, and full sentences:

nim i mo e mocen su e moaria	→ I eat chocolate and apple
nim i mo su i mouje	→ I eat and drink
nim i anvu su run	→ I go with you

16.2 Temporal Connectors

Word	Meaning
notam	first / before (the earlier event)
notor	then / second (the later event)
cali	when
lar	once / at some point in the past
noli	now
noi	here / this
yadetu	finally
tonan	suddenly

notam and notor mark order, not calendar time:

notam nim i mo, notor i bonfene	→ first I eat, then I lie down
notam nim i mo, i bonfene	→ (first) I eat, (then) I lie down

17. Numbers

17.1 Cardinal Numbers 1–10

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
tam	tor	par	balem	alui	teva	peri	auta	tenda	das

17.2 Numbers Beyond 10

Larger unit first:

```
das tam = 11    das par = 13    tor das = 20
par das = 30    par das balem = 34
```

17.3 Ordinals

Add -ganter to any cardinal: tam ganter = first, tor ganter = second, par ganter = third

17.4 Time Units

Word	Meaning	Built from
litam	day	li + tam (1)
liperi	week	li + peri (7)
lipardas	month	li + pardas (30)
lidastor	year	li + dastor (12)

```
litamar = yesterday    litamis = tomorrow
liperiar = last week    liperaris = next week
```

17.5 Large Numbers — nen / ponen

ponen (power), short form nen, base 10:

```
nen tor = 100 (10^2)
nen par = 1,000 (10^3)
nen teva = 1,000,000 (10^6)
nen tenda = 1,000,000,000 (10^9)
```

For example, one may say:

auta nen tor = 800

tor nen teva = 2,000,000

mir nen tenda = billions

17.6 Atomic Numbers — pogai

Chemical elements by pogai (atom) + atomic number:

```
pogai auta = oxygen (8)    pogai tor das teva = iron (26)
```

18. Fractional Numbers

Fractions use the pattern [numerator] de [denominator], literally "X of Y." de is the same "of/from" already in the grammar.

```
tam de tor    = 1 of 2 = half
tam de par    = 1 of 3 = a third
tam de alem   = 1 of 4 = a quarter
```

tam de das	= 1 of 10 = a tenth
tor de par	= 2 of 3 = two thirds

In use:

nim i mo e tam de tor	→ I ate half the food
hay i none e tam de balem de nen tor	→ she has a quarter of 100
a tam de tor de lidastor i dami	→ half a year remains (ligo can also be used, meaning "half")

For common fractions in everyday speech, the ne gradation system often serves just as well: nealui = 5/10 = half, neteva = 6/10 etc. Use the de construction when the exact fraction matters.

19. Existential Sentences — dami

dami (to exist / there is) forms existential statements:

i dami a moaria	→ there is an apple
cedom a bonfene i dami?	→ where is the bed?
en bo i dami a yunitam mo	→ in the house there is a special dish

20. Adjectives and Modifier Order

The modifier always comes first:

mogali moulu	→ coffee milk = coffee-flavored milk
yamirli heivio hai	→ old magic-doer = old witch

20.1 Compound Adjectives — the -a Suffix

Adding -a to a modifying word signals they are forming one concept, rather than working as an adjective:

Phrase	Reading
yaltan miau	a big cat (any big cat, descriptive)
yaltana miau	big-cat as a type = lion or tiger
yedia yaltana miau	striped-big-cat = tiger specifically
yahlul yaltan apafene	a seat that is soft and big
yahlula yaltana apafene	soft-big-seat = couch (concept)
nordaua vardei ja	far-eye tool = binoculars

Compounds are not exact science. If there is ambiguity, rephrase or add more words.

20.2 Imported Words and Scientific Names

Words not in the official vocabulary are preceded by ' (apostrophe). There are three cases:

- Names, places, languages — use the name the community uses: 'Italia, 'Nihongo
- Specific species — use the scientific name with a compound definition at first use
- Coined or created words — new words invented by a speaker for style or a concept not in the official list

For species and coined words, define the word at its first use with a compound:

```
En borlu, i vardei e 'miautan.  
*miautan = yedia yaltana miau, *panthera tigris*
```

The ' signals to the reader: this word is not in the core vocabulary, so look for a definition nearby. Imported and coined words never enter the permanent vocabulary. The compound is the definition. When in doubt, use the compound directly; the ' form is optional shorthand for repeated use within a text.

21. Adverbs and the Adjective/Adverb Distinction

In Oravia, any word can function as a modifier. Context usually makes the adjective/adverb reading clear. When disambiguation is needed, three strategies are available:

21.1 Compound Verb

Hyphenate the modifier to the verb to signal it modifies the action, not a noun:

```
nim i yasoi-apavu      → I fast-run / I run fast  
(yasoi bound to apavu: the running is fast)
```

21.2 Fronted Modifier Outside the Verb Block

Place the modifier outside the verb block to signal it applies to the action as a whole:

```
yasoi nim i apavu      → fast, I run = I run fast  
(yasoi outside [nim] and [i apavu] blocks)
```

21.3 Adjective Use

A modifier before a noun reads as an adjective:

```
a yasoi apavu          → a fast runner  
a yaltan bo            → a big house  
a yamirli heivio hai   → an old witch
```


21.4 Explicit Markers

For absolute clarity, use the explicit role markers:

non (way/manner) marks an adverbial phrase:

```
|nim i apavu non yasoi → I run in a fast way
```

ya (objective quality) marks an adjectival reading explicitly:

```
|a ya anro ilhei → a person who has the quality of decision,  
|decisive
```

These explicit markers are optional in most contexts but resolve ambiguity in complex sentences.

22. Comparison

22.1 Comparative — ga

ga means "compared to." It introduces the reference point:

```
|ga [x], a [y] a [adjective]  
|compared to x, y is more [adjective]
```

```
|ga nime fasujal, a nim a yamirli → I am older than my brother  
|a nime bo a yaltan ga rune → my house is bigger than yours
```

22.2 Equality — gaomem

gaomem means "the same." With ga it expresses "as [adjective] as":

```
|ga run, a nim a gaomem yalen → I am as tall as you  
|a haye dairan a gaomem de nime → her preference is the same as mine
```

22.3 Superlative — anodu

anodu means "top / the most." Use de to specify the group:

```
|a [y] a anodu [adjective] de [group]
```

```
|a rune fano a anodu yalen → your child is the tallest  
|a nime fatore a anodu yunro de fatore → my teacher is the smartest
```

23. The ne Gradation System

ne + number expresses degree on a scale from 0 to 10. It applies to any gradable word:

Expression	Meaning
nesunya [word]	0/10 — not at all
netor [word]	2/10 — a little
nepar [word]	3/10 — somewhat
nealem [word]	4/10 — fairly
nealui [word]	5/10 — halfway
neteva [word]	6/10 — rather
neperi [word]	7/10 — quite
neauta [word]	8/10 — very
nedas [word]	10/10 — completely
nedastam [word]	11/10 — too much

With *lirul* (habit) — frequency:

nesunya <i>lirul</i> = never	nepar <i>lirul</i> = sometimes
neauta <i>lirul</i> = often	nedas <i>lirul</i> = every time

With *ilie* (likelihood):

nesunya <i>ilie</i> = impossible	nealui <i>ilie</i> = 50/50
neperi <i>ilie</i> = likely	nedas <i>ilie</i> = certainly

With a context word — precise descriptions:

nebalem antori = 4/10 open = ajar
nepar luyar = 3/10 light = dimly lit

24. Pluralization and Definiteness

24.1 Pluralization

Oravia has no plural morphology. The bare noun covers both singular and plural; context usually makes the number clear:

miau i bonfene	→ a cat is sleeping / cats are sleeping
----------------	---

When explicit plurality is needed, use *mir* (many) or a number directly before the noun:

mir miau	→ many cats
tor miau	→ two cats
par das miau	→ thirty cats

mir can also float outside the noun block when it modifies the event broadly:

nim i vardei e mir miau	→ I see many cats
-------------------------	-------------------

mir, nim i vardei e miau	→ I see cats many times / repeatedly
--------------------------	--------------------------------------

24.2 Definiteness

There are no articles. Definiteness is handled pragmatically: first mention is typically indefinite, subsequent mention is definite. When additional specificity is needed, demonstratives or context words anchor the reference:

o miau	→ the cat (o = emphasis)
noi miau	→ this cat (noi = here/this)
tam ganter litam	→ the first day (in a sequence)

25. The Focus Marker o

o is the fifth sentence marker. It spotlights whatever immediately follows it.

General emphasis

o nim!	→ it's ME!
o nima i anvu	→ WE are going
i anona o u run	→ I give it to YOU

Before a verb — imperative

When o precedes a verb without a specified subject, it reads as a command:

o i anona!	→ Give it!
o yadetu!	→ Stop!
o i anvu!	→ Go!

Before the object — passive

When o precedes an e-marked object, the object becomes the focus. This is the main passive construction in Oravia:

o e leirih i vonlu	→ the tree was touched
i yean o e yemiodu	→ the pillow was sewn
a eofa i vanpai o e falen	→ the kid was kicked by the friend

Summary:

o [word]	→ emphasis / spotlight
o i [verb]	→ imperative
o e [object]	→ passive

Own — Possession with Emphasis

Oravia has no separate word for "own." To express "my own", place o before the possessive phrase:

nime bo	→ my house
o nime bo	→ my OWN house / specifically my house
de elihei	→ of self (if additional clarity is needed)

The o marker already in the language carries the meaning; no new vocabulary needed.

26. Passive Voice

Oravia has two ways to build passive constructions.

26.1 o e — Emphasis on object (event passive)

The most common passive uses the o marker before the e-marked object. The subject recedes; the object becomes the focus:

o e leirih i vonlu	→ the tree was touched
i yean o e yemiodu	→ the pillow was sewn
a eofo i vanpai o e falen	→ the kid was kicked by the friend

26.2 hue — Resultant state passive

hue after a verb describes the resulting state, not the event itself, but how things stand now:

a coupa a ancem hue	→ the card is turned (current state)
---------------------	--------------------------------------

26.3 Choosing between them

o e coupa i anopu	→ the card was lost (event narration)
a coupa a anopu hue	→ the card is lost (current state)

27. Contrastive Emphasis

The o marker can be used to identify precisely which element in a sentence is being highlighted or negated. Moving o to different positions creates different meanings; it's the same marker from §11, just used analytically to resolve ambiguity.

nim i moum e mocen	→ I don't eat chocolate (neutral negation)
o nim i moum e mocen	→ it's specifically ME who doesn't eat chocolate (others might)

```
nim o i moum e mocen  
→ the eating is what I don't do with chocolate (I might use it differently)
```

It comes in handy for corrections and clarifications. When you need to specify which part of a claim is wrong, place *o* before that element:

```
A: nim i ilaluan ca run i anifar.  
B: noder, o run i anifar hue de nim – it's not that you left but that I  
left (correction: it's ME that left, not you)
```

You can also use negation of specific parts of the sentence:

```
nim i mo e mocenum  
→ I am eating something it's just not chocolate
```

28. The Speaker Comment Marker *bi*

bi introduces the speaker's emotional reaction or editorial commentary: not neutral content, but how the speaker feels about what is being said. *bi* phrases can be inserted anywhere and can stand alone:

```
nim i faigel bi oipoh!      → I'm getting married – how exciting!  
bi oila a nim en bo        → I'm so happy to be home  
bi tohpu!                  → How sad! / I'm so sad about this!  
bi oipoh!                  → How exciting!
```

29. Sentence-Final and Clause-Final Particles

Many languages use small particles at the end of sentences to add emotional tone, epistemic stance, or pragmatic coloring. Oravia handles most of this through a small set of elements that can appear in sentence-final or clause-final position.

29.1 *bi* — Emotional / Editorial Comment

bi is the primary one. It can appear anywhere but naturally gravitates toward sentence-final or pre-comment positions:

```
nim i faigel, bi oipoh!      → I'm getting married – how exciting!  
a nim en bo noli, bi oila    → I'm home now, how wonderful  
hay i anvu, bi tohpu        → she's leaving – how sad
```

Alone, *bi* phrases work as pure exclamation:

```
bi oipoh!      → how exciting!  
bi tohpu!      → how sad!  
bi oila!       → wonderful! / I'm so glad!
```

29.2 ilie — Epistemic Hedging

ilie (maybe/likelihood) at the end of a sentence softens it into a possibility or expresses the speaker's uncertainty:

nim i anvu ilie	→ I might go / I'm going maybe
hay i anifi litamis ilie	→ she might arrive tomorrow

29.3 o — Spotlight / Assertion

o at the end of a phrase or sentence puts final emphasis on what just came, asserting it or marking it as the key point:

o hay !	→ it's HER! (not someone else)
o noi	→ right here (emphasis on the location)
hay o i anifar	→ she DID leave

29.4 The System as a Whole

These three (bi, ilie, and o) cover the main functions of sentence-final particles cross-linguistically:

Element	Function	Analogy
bi	emotional/editorial commentary	Japanese ね、よ、わ... and more
ilie	epistemic uncertainty / softening	English "maybe", Japanese かも
o	spotlight / assertion / emphasis	Japanese ぞ、よ (assertive)

The system is deliberately minimal; these three elements combine to cover a wide range of pragmatic coloring.

30. Only and Also/Too

30.1 netam — Only

netam (from ne + tam = single/one) means "only." It precedes what it restricts, just like other modifiers:

nim i anidai netam e mogali	→ I want only coffee
netam o nim i none	→ only I have it
a netam litam i dami	→ there is only one day left
hay i anifar netam caora tohpu	→ she left only because of sadness

30.2 su — Also/Too

su already appears as the connector "and/also/with" (placed before or between elements). When placed after a word, it takes on the meaning "also / too," emphasizing that the word it follows is included in addition to something already established.

The position distinguishes the two uses:

```
Before/between = "and/with" (connector):
nim su run i anvu          → I and you go / I go with you

After a word = "also/too" (focus):
hay i anifar su            → she also left / she left too
nim i mo, hay su           → I eat; she does too
neloa i mo su              → everyone also eats
```

The "also/too" use of su is the same word; context and position make the reading clear.

31. Already, Not Yet, Still, No Longer

These four expressions are extremely common in everyday speech. In Oravia they are built from two roots (norven = already, anlaro = continue) with the negation suffix -um.

Expression	Built from	Meaning
noder	norder	already
noderum	noder + -um	not yet (not already)
anlaro	anlaro	still (continues to)
anlaroum	anlaro + -um	no longer (does not continue)

```
nim i moar noder          → I already ate
noder hay i anifar        → she has already left

nim i anlaro-mo           → I'm still eating
haya anlaro i eleme en bo → they still live at home
```

32. Relative Clauses

Oravia forms relative clauses using the same connectors introduced in §9: ca, caei, cadom, cali, caora, canon, cane. The connector comes immediately after the noun being modified and introduces the subordinate clause. There is no separate relative pronoun; the connector slot simply matches the grammatical role of the missing element within the relative clause.

The key connectors and their roles in relative clauses:

Connector	Use in relative clause
ca	replaces a thing (object, fact): the food that, the idea that

caei	replaces a person: the person who
cadom	replaces a place: the house where
cali	replaces a time: the day when
caora	replaces a reason: the reason why
canon	replaces a manner: the way in which

Examples:

```

a hei caei i ilaluan u nim
the person who told me
(hei = person; caei replaces the subject of ilaluan)

a bo cadom nim i elemi
the house where I live
(cadom replaces the location)

a mo ca nim i anidai
the food that I want
(ca replaces the object of anidai)

a litam cali nim i anifar
the day when I left
(cali replaces the time)

```

Whose and With Which

For whose we can rephrase the sentence, or use "cade" (ca + de, possessive):

```

faejal cade fano nim i ilian
(the man whose child I know)

```

"With which / using which" — the knife with which I cut bread:

```

a jahvel ca nim i anja i jasrec e malvae
(the knife that I use to cut bread)

jasrec malvae jahvel
(cut bread modifying knife)

```

Just use ca (that/which) and include the instrumental relationship inside the clause using anja (instrument relational word). No special "with which" form is needed; the role is expressed by the relational word within the relative clause.

33. Reported and Direct Speech

33.1 Reported Speech

Reported (indirect) speech uses *ca* as the connector between the speech verb and the reported clause. The reported clause takes its own markers as if it were a standalone sentence, with no change of person or tense required, since Oravia has no obligatory marking:

```
nim i ilaluan ca hay i anvu  
I said that he is going  
  
haya i ilaluan ca a nim a ti  
they said that I am bad  
  
nime farejor i ilaluan ca litamis i dami a yuba mo  
my mother said that tomorrow there will be good food
```

33.2 Direct Speech

Direct (verbatim) speech uses *no* as connector, or quotations. The quoted speech follows the speech verb immediately:

```
nim i ilaluan no hay i anvu  
I said: he is going  
  
nime farejor i ilaluan "litamis i dami a yuba mo"  
my mother said "tomorrow there will be good food"
```

34. Coordination Within Phrases

su (and/also/with) works at both the sentence level and inside phrases. Its position determines what it coordinates. This resolves a common English ambiguity:

34.1 Coordinating Adjectives (One Noun)

su between two adjectives before a noun = both adjectives modify the same noun:

```
yohisa su yoyol beivu → red-and-blue vehicle  
(one vehicle that is both red and blue)  
  
yuba su yunro hai → good-and-smart person  
(one person who is both)
```

34.2 Coordinating Noun Phrases (Multiple Nouns)

su between two full noun phrases = two separate referents:

```
yohisa beivu su yoyol beivu → red vehicle and blue vehicle  
(two separate vehicles)  
  
yuba hai su yunro hai → a good person and a smart person
```

(two people)

34.3 Coordinating Verbs and Objects

The same logic applies to verbs and objects:

```
nim i mo su i mouje      → I eat and drink (two verbs)
nim i mo e mocen su e moaria → I eat chocolate and apple (two objects)
nim i mo e mocen su nim i mouje e mogali
→ I eat chocolate, and I drink coffee (two full clauses)
```

35. Correlatives

Correlatives are expressions like "everyone," "somewhere," "nothing," "always." In Oravia these are not separate words to memorize, they are built by combining the three main quantity words with domain words already in the vocabulary.

35.1 Quantity Words

```
sunya    → no / none / not any
nehen    → each
noniu    → some / a certain
neloa    → all / every
```

35.2 Combining with Domain Words

Add a domain word to specify the type of referent. The most common combinations:

```
+ ilhei (person/self)
  sunya ilhei    → no one
  nehen ilhei    → each person
  noniu ilhei    → someone
  neloa ilhei    → everyone

+ dom (place)
  sunya dom      → nowhere
  nehen dom      → each place
  noniu dom      → somewhere
  neloa dom      → everywhere

+ ora (idea / reason)
  sunya ora      → for no reason
  nehen ora      → each reason
  noniu ora      → for some reason
  neloa ora      → for any reason / every reason

+ mo (food / thing in context)
  sunya mo       → nothing to eat / nothing [in food context]
  nehen mo       → each food
  noniu mo       → something to eat
```

```
neloa mo      → everything, all the food
```

Any domain word works; the pattern is fully open. *noniu litam* = some day, *sunya elemi dom* = nowhere to live, *neloa de nim* = everything of mine.

35.3 Dropping the Domain Word

When the referent type is clear from context, the domain word drops. The quantity word alone carries the full meaning:

```
neloa i ilian      → everyone knows  
(ilhei dropped – the subject slot already implies a person-doer)  
  
noniu i dami en bo  → something is in the house  
  
neloa a ancem hue   → everything has been turned
```

That's the norm in speech. The full form (*neloa ilhei*, *neheh ilhei*) is used when the domain genuinely needs to be made explicit or for emphasis.

36. Conditionals

36.1 iliciu — Counterfactual / Imagined

Use *iliciu* for hypothetical, contrary-to-fact, or imagined situations. Oravia doesn't need complex verb forms; *iliciu* carries all that meaning:

```
iliciu a nim a yalen      → imagine I were tall / if I were tall  
iliciu nim i anivariun    → if I hadn't left
```

36.2 daehun — Factual If-Then

Use *daehun* for logical truths and real-world cause-and-effect:

```
daehun nim i apanou e moaria, a moaria i apanou  
if I drop the apple, it falls
```

37. Concession — *noder* + *mai*

Noder means "even." Paired with *mai* (but), it expresses concession, as in "even though X, Y." The structure is: *noder* [conceded clause], *mai* [main clause].

```
Nim i none e beivu, mai i dai i vanvu.  
I have a car, but I like to walk.
```

Noder nim i none e beivu, mai i dai i vanvu.
Even (though) I have a car, I like to walk.

Nim i eodya hue, mai anvum.
I was invited, but I am not going.

Noder nim i eodya hue, mai anvum.
Even (though) I was invited, I am not going.

noder alone works as "even" in other contexts, as a focus/degree word before a word or clause:

noder nim i ando	→ even I can
noder nepar	→ even a little
noder norvenum	→ not even yet

38. The More... The More...

The correlative neron (more / additional) can be doubled across two clauses to express the proportional relationship "the more X, the more Y." From the North Wind and Sun reading:

neron hay i 'asufu, neron be hai i vanta e jovabo en hay
the more it blew, the more the traveler held his cloak around him

The pattern: neron [first clause], neron [second clause]. The two neron phrases work just like the English "the more... the more..." — each intensification of the first event drives an intensification of the second.

neron nim i ilaluan, neron nim i ando
the more I speak, the more I can

neron haya i mo, neron haya a yunro
the more they eat, the smarter they are

For the reverse ("the more X, the less Y"), combine neron with gafi or a negated form:

neron nim i bonfene, gafi nim i apavu
the more I sleep, the less I run

39. Relational Words

Oravia has words that work like prepositions, specifying the semantic relationship between a phrase and the rest of the sentence. Unlike English prepositions, these are full content words with their own meanings. They always introduce a block and travel with it.

39.1 sora / dasora — Purpose

sora (short for dasora) marks the purpose or goal of an action. In English: "in order to," "to," "for the purpose of":

nim i anvu sora i gerina	→ I go to buy / in order to buy
e coupa i anja sora daelipo	→ the cards are used for prophecy

39.2 jetai — Direction

jetai marks direction toward something. In English: "toward," "in the direction of":

nim i anvu jetai bo	→ I go toward the house
hay i anvu e varsus jetai nim	→ she directed her ear toward me (listened)

jetai is directional, not locational. Compare:

nim i dami en bo	→ I am at home (static location)
nim i anvu jetai bo	→ I go toward the house (direction of movement)

39.3 anja — Instrument

anja marks the tool or means used to accomplish something. In English: "using," "by means of," "with" (instrumental):

nim i ilaluan anja coupa	→ I communicate by card
nim i mo anja ja	→ I eat with utensils
nim i anvu anja bei	→ I travel by vehicle

anja is also a standalone verb meaning "to use" (nim i anja e coupa = I use the card).

39.4 caora — Reason (relational use)

caora appears as a connector (because / the reason) but also introduces a reason phrase:

nim i tohpu caora siur de haye	→ I am sad because of her disappearance
nim i moum caora tidar	→ I don't eat because of illness

As connector (introduces a clause):

caora nim i toumo, i mo	→ because I'm hungry, I eat
-------------------------	-----------------------------

39.5 lor — Benefit

lor (from anlor) deepens the meaning of u by marking that an action is done specifically for someone's benefit, not just directed at them as a recipient, but genuinely serving their interest.

Compare u and u lor:

nim i anye u run	→ I do it for you (you are the recipient)
nim i anye u lor run	→ I do it for your benefit (a gift / act of service for you)

u marks who receives. u lor adds that the action is a meaningful gift or service done out of care or generosity: the difference between handing someone something and genuinely doing something for them.

nim i boemo u lor run	→ I cook for your benefit (as a kindness)
hay i ilaluan u lor haya	→ she told them for their sake (to help them)
nim i copei e coupa u lor nima	→ I searched for the card for our sake

This maps some natural languages, for example Japanese ageru and Portuguese por as distinct from para. u lor has the flavor of a deeper gift or act of service.

40. Location and Spatial Words

40.1 en — Location

en marks location (at, in, on) and time spans:

nim i eleme en 'San Antonio	→ I live in San Antonio
hay en bo	→ she is at home
nim i copei en mir lidastor	→ I searched for many years
en liyar	→ in the morning

40.2 Spatial Vocabulary

Word	Meaning
en	at / in / on (location)
jenpur	under / below
ganrih	above / over / up
jenparo	front / forward
anolu	out / away / external
jetai	direction / toward
noi	here
nordau	far
widuo	near / close by

41. no — Similative and Nominal Complement

no means "like / as / similar to." One of the most versatile words in the language, it has two related uses.

41.1 Similitive — comparing actions or manners

Use *no* to describe how something is done, or what something resembles in behavior:

hay i vanvu no yamirli	→ she walks like an old person
hay i neiden no falo	→ she runs like a young one
hay i nomie no toulum	→ she moves sluggishly (like tiredness)

no always comes before what it modifies.

41.2 Nominal Complement — secondary predicate after a verb

no also serves as a nominal complement — it introduces what something is called, considered, or perceived as.

Some verbs this appears with: *ilaluan* (call/say), *daelan* (judge/consider), *vardei* (see/perceive), *nomie* (appear/seem), *anona* (treat as).

nim i ilaluan e run no hehma	→ I call you a monster
nim i daelan e hay no ti bad	→ I judge him as bad / I consider him bad
i nomie no yufer	→ it looks dirty / it appears dirty
haya i anona e hay no eofa	→ they treated him as a friend
nim i vardei e run no anivari hai	→ I see you as a savior

The pattern is [verb] *e* [object] *no* [characterization], where the *no* phrase tells you what the object is being called, judged, or perceived as. Compare with the copula for direct identity:

a run a hehma	→ you ARE a monster (direct statement)
nim i ilaluan e run no hehma	→ I CALL you a monster (framing via verb)

42. Sensory and Perceptual Constructions

nomie means "to move/seem/appear" in a general sense. Combined with *no* (like/as), it covers the English "it seems," "it appears," "it looks like," etc.:

i nomie no lupupi	→ it seems like rain / it looks like rain
i nomie no elemi	→ it seems inhabited / it appears to be lived in

To specify which sense is involved, combine *nomie* with the relevant sensory word, either hyphenated or as a separate block:

vardei (eye / sight):	
i nomie-vardei no lupupi	→ it looks like rain

```

i nomie no lupupi daciū → it looks like rain (shape)

varsus (ear / hearing):
i nomie-varsus no lupupi → it sounds like rain
i nomie no lupupi om → it sounds like rain (sound)

varpi (nose / smell):
i nomie-varpi no lupupi → it smells like rain
i nomie no lupui varpi → it smells like rain

varluan (tongue / taste):
i nomie-varluan no moval mogali → it tastes like iced coffee

```

The sensory word specifies the modality; no introduces the comparison. Without a sensory word, nomie no is the general "seems/appears like" applicable to any perception or impression.

43. Causatives

Causative constructions use verb stacking with pohnen (power, to impose). The causee (the entity being made to do something) takes the e (object) marker as the direct object of pohnen. The caused action follows with i:

```

i pohnen ca e [causee] i [caused action]

nim i pohnen ca e hay i mo
I made that him eat
(I imposed on him: eat)

nime farejor i pohnen ca e nim i bonfene
my mother made me lie down

haya i pohnen ca e falen i ilaluan
they made the child speak

```

Ca may be omitted if it's clear.

The strength of imposition scales with context. pohnen implies genuine forcing or imposition. For a softer "cause to / allow to," the relational words u lor (for the benefit of) or sora (purpose) can be used instead in constructions where the causation is more facilitative.

44. Reflexives and Reciprocals

Word	Meaning
elihei	self
fene	each other

haya i vardei e elihei	→ they look at themselves
haya i vardei e fene	→ they look at each other
nim i ilaluan u elihei	→ I talk to myself

45. Instead — domvio

domvio (dom = place + davio = change) means "instead," as in: in the place of, as a substitute for. It works as a relational word introducing the thing being replaced:

nim i mouje domvio i mo	→ I drank instead of eating
domvio mo, nim i mouje	→ instead of eating, I drank
hay i anvu domvio nim	→ she went instead of me
hay i anvu domvio lor nim	→ she went instead of me (as a sacrifice or gift)

domvio can also be used as a verb meaning "to substitute / to take the place of":

nim i domvio e hay en nime anse	→ I substituted for her in my job
a mogali i domvio e moulu	→ coffee replaced milk

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46. Become, Turn Into, Start To

Oravia expresses "become," "turn into," and "start to" through two roots: ansau (start) and ancem (turn / change state).

ansau — start

Ansau means "to start." Stack it with another verb to express "begin doing / start to". Just as with other verb stacking, you can use short form:

nim i ansau i toului	→ I start to be tired / I get tired
nim i sau i ilian	→ I start to understand / I come to understand
hay i sau i anvu	→ she starts going / she starts to leave

davio — change into / become

Davio means "change", you can use "no" or "u" as complement:

nim i davio no roena hai	→ I become a teacher
--------------------------	----------------------

(I turn into being a teacher)

a jevial i davio u lenodur → the statue turns into stone

hay i davio u yamirli → she is becoming old / she turns old

For "get [adjective]" (get tired, get warm), both can apply depending on whether you emphasize the start of the process or arrival at the new state:

nim i ansau i toului → I start getting tired (process beginning)

nim i davio u toului → I become tired (arrival at state)

Remember as well that you can use any word as a verb:

i yohisa e borcai → to turn/to make the wall red (lit. to red the wall)

47. Wish and Jussive

47.1 bi iloi — Wish

bi iloi (bi = speaker comment + iloi = hope) expresses a wish or hope about something: events the speaker wants but cannot command:

bi iloi hay i anefene → I wish/hope she would rest

bi iloi a litamis a yuba → I hope tomorrow is good

bi iloi nim i do i anifar → I wish I could leave

bi iloi run i anifar → I hope you leave

47.2 o i — Jussive (Let's)

The same o i [verb] construction used for commands (§11) also covers the first-person plural invitation ("let's"). Context makes the reading clear: this can be like an order or invitation.

o i mo! → Let's (we) eat! / eat

If you don't want to be read like an order, you can use ""what do you think":

ce iliro nima i mo → what do you think we eat

48. Register and Style

Oravia has a natural formal-to-informal spectrum. Neither end is wrong; they just signal different contexts and relationships.

48.1 The Spectrum

Feature	Formal → Informal
Markers	All explicit → a drops first, then e; u rarely drops
Verb forms	Full (anidai, anifou) → Short root (dai, fou)
Aspect	-ar and -is used → Bare verb common
Possessives	Explicit → Dropped when obvious
Sentences	Complete → Fragments acceptable

48.2 Dropping Markers

Formal:	a nim i mo e mocen	
Standard:	nim i mo e mocen	(a dropped)
Casual:	nim i mo mocen	(a and e dropped)
Very casual:	i mo?	(just the verb)

48.3 Short vs. Long Verb Forms

Formal:	nim i anidai i bonfene	(anidai – full form)
Casual:	nim i dai i bonfene	(dai – short form)
Very casual:	nim i dai i fene	(both short forms)

Example from more to less formal

```
a nim i anidai i bonfene -> formal
nim i anidai i bonfene
nim i dai i bonfene
i dai i bonfene
i dai i fene
i dai fene
dai fene -> rough speech
```

48.4 Bare Verbs vs. Aspect

Bare verbs are the norm in casual speech. Add -ar or -is only when completion state genuinely matters.

48.5 Affectionate Short Forms

Doubling the short root creates affectionate or childlike diminutives:

daidai	→ (from anidai) = want (trying to look cute) or gimme (childlike)
tornono	→ (from fatorno = grandchild) = dear grandchild

49. Apposition and Common Discourse Phrases

49.1 Apposition

A noun can be immediately followed by another noun that specifies its identity, without any marker or connector between them. The second noun narrows or names the first:

eofa 'Mark	→ my friend Mark
couya "miau"	→ the word "miau"
jerih 'Babel	→ the Tower of Babel
farejor 'Ana	→ my mother Ana

It works because modifier-before-modified order already governs noun phrases, so the second noun functions as a tight specification of the first. Use the apostrophe prefix for names and imported words as usual.

49.2 Common Discourse Phrases

Several existing Oravia words and combinations function naturally as sentence-initial framing phrases, analogous to "in fact," "for example," etc. in English. None of these are special constructions; they're just familiar words used in a framing position:

elireva,	→ in fact / truly (true)
eta,	→ therefore / consequently
mai,...	→ however / on the other hand...
eomfel,	→ for example (instance)
neloa lirul,	→ always / in every case
noniu lirul,	→ sometimes / in some cases
yadetu,	→ finally
lar,	→ once / at some point in the past (story-opening framing)
lis,	→ one day, in the future
o iliciu	→ imagine / hypothetically
bi yuba,	→ fortunately (speaker comment: good)
bi tohpu,	→ unfortunately (speaker comment: sad)

These phrases sit in the sentence-initial position and are typically followed by a comma in writing. Like other modifier blocks, they can be moved freely, but front position gives them their framing weight.

50. Ambiguities English Has That Oravia Doesn't

Many English ambiguities arise from word-order dependence, dual-function words, or unclear modifier attachment. Because Oravia marks grammatical roles explicitly with particles, and because any word can function as verb or noun, many of these don't exist.

50.1 Attachment Ambiguity — the Classic Binoculars Example

English: "I saw the man using binoculars" has two readings:

- Reading A: I used binoculars to see the man (binoculars belong to me)
- Reading B: I saw the man who was using binoculars (binoculars belong to the man)

In Oravia, these are unambiguous:

```
Reading A – binoculars are the verb (I performed a binocular-seeing
action):
i nordau-jadei e faejal
(V: far-eye-tool  OBJ: man)

Reading B – binoculars accompany the man (relative clause or
accompaniment):
i vardei e faejal su nordau-jadei
(V: see  OBJ: man  WITH: far-eye-tool)
or:
i vardei e faejal caei i nordau-jadei
(V: see  OBJ: man  WHO: used binoculars)
```

Any word can be used as a verb. Turning *nordau-jadei* (far-eye-tool) into a verb makes it unambiguously the action, not a prop.

50.2 Role Ambiguity

English "the professor's picture" — is the professor the painter, the subject, or the owner?

```
a daciū de roena hai      → the professor's picture (ownership or
depiction)
a roena hai i anye daciū   → the picture he made (he is the maker)
```

If modifying excerpts become too large, it can get confusing, so prefer to rephrase (e.g., *e daciū ca a roena hai i anye*).

50.3 Modifier Scope

English "old men and women" — are the women also old, or only the men? In Oravia, scope is explicit:

```
yamirli faejal su faejor
→ old men and women (yamirli modifies only faejal before su)

yamirli faejal su yamirli faejor
→ old men and old women (explicit yamirli for both)
```

51. Evidentiality

Oravia has an optional evidential system built on *bi*. Because *bi* already marks speaker stance, evidential phrases read as a natural extension of the same system: rather than just commenting, the speaker also notes the source of their knowledge. A sentence without an evidential marker makes no claim about source. Adding one phrases the same assertion with an epistemic note about how the speaker knows.

The Three Evidential Markers

Phrase	Built from	Meaning
<i>bi eosus</i>	<i>bi</i> + <i>eosus</i> (social hearing)	I heard this / reported evidence
<i>bi daeniu</i>	<i>bi</i> + <i>daeniu</i> (witness)	I witnessed this / direct evidence
<i>bi daeta</i>	<i>bi</i> + <i>daeta</i> (inference)	I inferred this / evidential reasoning

bi evidential phrases sit clause-finally, like other *bi* phrases:

```
hay i anifiar bi daeniu
she left — I witnessed this
bi eosus a hay a tohpu
he is sad — I heard this
a bo a anolum hue, bi daeta
the house seems abandoned — I'm inferring this
```

They can also stand alone as a comment on a prior statement:

```
A: hay i faigel.
B: bi eosus — I heard the same.
```

Bi evidentials and bi emotional comments

Both use *bi*, but the words are distinct in meaning and feel. Emotional *bi* phrases (*bi oipoh*, *bi tohpu*, *bi oila*) express how the speaker feels about the content. Evidential *bi* phrases express where the knowledge comes from. In practice the two don't conflict and they can be combined:

```
hay i anifiar, bi eosus, bi tohpu
she left — I heard this — how sad
```

52. Word-Building

52.1 Cluster Sounds

Words are built from sounds that carry consistent semantic fields. There are 800 words, mostly formed from 259 building blocks (syllable-meaning associations).

The opening sounds signal the cluster. As vocabulary grows, the patterns become intuitive, and you can often guess new words by their sounds alone.

52.2 Hyphenated words

Combine roots freely. A hyphen aids readability:

ilofun-vardei	→ hesitant-look = to peek with doubt
anivari-anita	→ back-take = retrieve
toului-asfe	→ tired-stop = give up
raidana-ilaluan	→ surrender-say = concede

52.3 Verb-Noun Flexibility

Any noun becomes a verb with i: i boemo = to cook, i bonfene = to lie down, i bortal = to enter/exit

52.4 The -a Compound Suffix

-a bonds modifiers into a single concept (see §14.1). It's the primary tool for creating new vocabulary without adding new words.

52. Word-Building in Depth

52.1 How the Cluster System Works

Every Oravia word begins with a sound (or sound sequence) that signals its semantic cluster. This isn't tagging; the sounds carry meaning. The cluster sound is the first building block of the word, and all words starting with that sound will be conceptually related.

It creates a predictable map: once you know the ~48 cluster sounds, you have a framework for the entire vocabulary. Even an unknown word gives you a domain just from its first syllable.

```
mi__ = larger animals
  mihie = horse
  mibeh = goat
  mimu  = cow
  miogar = bear (MIO subcluster: wild animals)

mo__ = food / eating
  mogali = coffee
  moaria = apple
  moulu  = milk
  boemo  = kitchen (BO+E+MO compound: house-room-food)
```

Subclusters refine the domain. The third letter (or first two letters of the second syllable) narrows within the cluster:

```
AN (action, movement)
```

ANE = static actions (rest, stop, stay)
 ANI = movement toward (arrive, bring, attract)
 ANO = movement away (leave, push, send)

52.2 Cross-Cluster Roots

Some roots appear across clusters and add a consistent meaning wherever they appear. The building blocks make Oravia highly guessable. Here are some examples:

Root	Meaning	Examples
mir	many / lots of	yamirli (old = many-time quality), mir miao (many cats)
yar	light / radiant	luyar (lamp/light), oiyar (to emphasize)
non	way / path / manner	jenon (path), canon (how/in what way)
tam	one / single / first	litam (day = time-1), yunitam (special)
li	time	lirul (habit), noli (now)
dom	place / location	cedom (where?), ledom (land)
ei	person	cei (who?), caei (who), ilhei (person)

Recognizing these cross-cluster roots lets you parse unfamiliar words without a dictionary. For example, even without knowing elirevaum as a word, a speaker who knows eli (virtue), reva (accurate), and -um (negation) can derive its meaning.

52.3 Compound Formation Patterns

Oravia builds new vocabulary from compounds rather than borrowing. The main patterns:

Pattern	Example	Meaning
cluster + cluster	boemo (BOE+MO)	kitchen (house room+food)
adjective-a + noun	"yaltana miao"	tiger (big-cat as concept)
verb stacking for roles	boemo hai	cook (kitchen-user)
ne + number + quality	neauta yasoi	very fast (8/10 fast)
time + number	lidastor (li+das+tor)	year (time-12)

53. Cluster Reference Table

Approximately 48 main clusters organize the Oravia vocabulary. Each cluster is identified by its opening sound(s). Words beginning with those sounds belong to that cluster's semantic domain. Subclusters (shown indented) refine the domain further.

Sound	Domain	Key subclusters
-------	--------	-----------------

AN	action / movement	ANE static · ANI toward · ANO away · APA physical · AS involuntary body · ASE affectionate contact · ASI orifice · ASU involuntary vocal
BE	travel	BEI vehicles
BO	home interior	BOE house spaces · BON furniture · BOR structure · BOS hygiene fixtures
CIU	creative products	—
CO	communication	COU written communication
DA	evaluation / knowledge	DAE epistemic · DAN emphasis
DO	regulations	DOH enforcement
EL	wonder / virtue	ELA religious · ELE self-expansion · ELI virtue · ELO prosocial
EO	social	EOD social interactions · EOM events & gatherings
FA	family	FAE gender · FAI partnership/marriage · FAL young ones
GA	comparison / ranking	GAN ranking · GAO value assessment
GE	finances	GEL trading
HE	fiction tropes	HEH antagonist · HEI protagonist · HEO background/setting
IL	inquiry / knowledge	ILA sharing information · ILI cognition · ILO uncertainty
JA	tools	JAH cutting tools · JAS gripping & fastening tools
JE	geometrics / space	JEN location · JEO geometric positions
JO	materials	JOL material types
LE	environment / land	LEA landscape · LEI plants
LI	time	LITE clock time · LUN seasons
LU	weather / atmosphere / outside	LUN seasons (shared)
MA	cooking / food preparation	MAE tubers & grains · MAL bread & dairy · MAS spices
MI	larger animals	MIO wild animals
MO	food / eating	MOA fruits · MOL food containers
MU	smaller animals	MUH flying animals / birds
NE	quantifiers / gradation	—
NO	function words	NOR relation to reference
OI	fun / excitement	—
OM	music / sound	—
PO	components / matter	POA chemical · POH energy · POI liquids
RA	society	RAI governance · RAN media & discourse · RAS culture
RO	knowledge / learning	ROE formal education · ROU written knowledge
SE	machines / technology	SEL coding · SEM systems
SI	processes	—

SIO	games / play	—
TI	harm / damage	TIU types of harm
TO	suffering / distress	TOH emotional · TOS interpersonal · TOU physical depletion
TU	conflict	TUL crash · TUM weapons
VA	core / body vitals	VAN limbs · VAR face · VEI health issues · VEL medical treatment
VI	interior body	VIR organs
VO	hygiene / personal care	VON external body surfaces · VOS grooming actions
WA	water / sea	—
WI	geographical orientation	WIL human-made geography · WIM natural geography
YA	objective qualities	YAH texture · YAL size
YE	clothing & fabric	YES garments
YO	colors	—
YU	subjective qualities	YUN personal characteristics

Even without knowing a specific word, the opening sound gives the domain. Subclusters narrow it further. The full vocabulary of ~800 words is distributed across these clusters.

54. Quick Reference — All Markers and Particles

Marker / Particle	Function
a	subject marker
i	verb marker
e	direct object marker
u	indirect object marker (to / for)
o	focus / emphasis; imperative; passive
en	location (at / in / on)
de	of / from / about; noun possession; agent in passive
-e	possessive suffix on pronouns
-jor / -jal	feminine / masculine suffix
-ar / -is	completed / prospective aspect
-um	negation
-a	compound modifier suffix
hai	agent / role suffix
hue	recipient / resultant state

ca / caei / cadom / cali / caora	connectors: that, who, where, when, because
canon / cane	connectors: how (manner) / as [degree] as
ce / cei / cedom / celi / ceora	question words: what, who, where, when, why
cemir / cenon / cene	question words: how many / how (manner) / how [degree]
su / dou / mai / eta	and, or, but, therefore
ho / no	opposite / like-as-similar to; nominal complement
ga / gaomem / anodu	comparative / equality / superlative
bi	speaker comment (emotional aside)
ne	gradation prefix (+ number)
sora / dasora	purpose / in order to
jetai	direction / toward
anja	instrument / by means of
lor	benefit marker — for someone's sake (used after u)
elihei / fene	self / each other
iliciu / daehun	counterfactual / factual conditional
lirul	habit
notam / notor	first event / second event
yadetu / tonan / lar / lis	finally / suddenly / once (past) / sometime in the future
noli / noi	now / here